ridiculed for putting stock in ‘myth’ and ‘fiction’. This demonstrates the manner in which the agency of the Indic consciousness over time and its subjectivity has become entirely subservient to the totalising nature of the casual coloniality we encounter in Bharat today. Ironically, the very same servile colonialised Indian mind would have no qualms accepting the historicity of the founder of the White European Christian coloniser’s faith as a given.

While undertaking an exercise that panoramically surveys Bharat’s history, consciousness and civilisation, Sarda posits that religion is *one* of the tests of civilisation. In the case of Bharat, according to him, *gnana* or knowledge is the true religion of Bharat, which was made possible only due to the ‘pre-eminence of morals, philosophy, literature, science and general culture’. While making a case for respecting the Indic consciousness, Sarda cautions against judging the past through the lens of the present given that the present is a far cry from the past.

Sarda defines the Hindu religion as an anthology of eternal truths as follows:

> The Hindu religion is the knowledge and comprehension of those eternal principles which govern nature and man, those immutable laws which in one sphere are called ‘science’, in another, ‘true philosophy’. It concerns itself not with things true under certain conditions or at certain times: its precepts are ever true, true in the past, true in the present, true in the future. True knowledge being one, it takes, without any distinction, into its fold, Indians, Arabs, Europeans, Americans, Africans and Chinese. Its principles circumscribe the globe and govern all humanity.

When the construct of ‘religion’ is reconsidered in light of this description, it is evident that the term does not do justice to Sanatana Dharma, exposing the problem of applying colonial Christian OET and linguistics to Bharat’s indigenous systems that are rooted in an onto-epistemology which is vastly different from that of the coloniser’s. Naturally, the White European Christian coloniser could not wrap his head around it and presumed that ethnicity and religion were as related in the Indic ‘religion’ as they were in his faith and worldview, which led to ethnocentric representations of Indic OET as well as its societal structures.